

IT CORRIDOR

Adyar » Kanathur » Kelambakkam » Navalur » Semmencherry » Thoraipakkam » Velachery » IIT Madras » Kandanchavadi » Kottivakkam

Neelankarai » Sholinganallur » Thiruvannamiyur » Vijaya Nagar » Indira Nagar » Karapakkam » Kotturpuram » Padur » Thalambur » Pallikaranai

Has OMR run out of those regular Jersey barriers?

In Sholinganallur, an assortment of discarded materials have been lined up to plug an access point to the service lane

PRINCE FREDERICK

Up to the 1980s, the tinkle of metal money (coins as currency) in the pouch was loud, the number of coin denominations being high in comparison to their current strength. In those days, it would not be unusual for someone to scrounge around for really low denomination coins to offer the seller the exact amount. Coins would be retrieved from unlikely spaces in the house. At the service lane of Old Mahabalipuram Road, right outside the Infosys office in Sholinganallur, one gets a sense of “coins” being gathered in this manner, hurriedly.

To close a wide entry point to the service lane, an assortment of discarded materials, some of them vestigial elements from the Metro Rail

work unfolding on the IT Corridor, have been lined up in the same manner a jagged defensive wall created by members of a football team up against a free kick.

Broken pillars, uprooted metal poles have been dragged into line to plug the gap.

If any of them sticks even a wee bit, there could be an accident on our hands. That would be ironical as these throwaways are stationed there to prevent accidents through limited and calculated access to service lane.

TNRDC is concerned with the road, and the traffic police with safe passage of motorists and pedestrians on that road. Metro Rail also has skin in the game. Can't any of them, or all of them together, make sure proper jersey barricades are placed to plug that entry point?



At the service lane on OMR, in front of the Infosys office in Sholinganallur. PHOTO: PRINCE FREDERICK

FOMRRA launches MLA Connect groups

Office bearers of residents associations of communities in Sholinganallur and Tiruppur constituencies can be part of these WhatsApp groups which would serve as a hotline to the MLAs and their teams



Harsha Koda with Sholinganallur MLA P. Saravanan. FILE PHOTO

The Federation of OMR Residents Associations (FOMRRA) has launched MLA-CONNECT WhatsApp groups to ensure to establish a direct, collaborative communication channel between residents and our elected representatives for Sholinganallur and Tiruppur.

A couple of months ago, while interacting with the candidates before the Assembly elections, FOMRRA had proposed the formation of these groups, says a FOMRRA press release.

These groups serve as a dedicated platform to bridge the gap between community needs and policy action; they focus on taking critical infrastructure challenges such as waste management, road quality and other civic amenities directly to the MLAs and their teams.

By bringing resident associations office bearers and administrative leadership into a single digital space, the groups aim to streamline communication and track the progress of ongoing public works.

Office bearers may reach out to FOMRRA for inclusion in these groups by messaging “SLL” or “TPR” on 9042366772 via WhatsApp.

You can be our volunteer writer

Dear readers, you can be our volunteer-writer by writing to us about issues and events in your neighbourhood. You should send the write-ups to downtownfeedback@thehindu.co.in. Letters must carry the contact number



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ROKA launches **third biogas unit** at GCC school in Kottur

The latest facility could be established with funding from Inner Wheel of Madras



At the launch.

Earlier this month, Residents of Kasturbanagar Association (ROKA) inaugurated its third biogas plant in a school, this time at Chennai High School in Kottur.

ROKA has set up these three biogas units, each in a different school, based on a mandate it re-

ceived from Greater Chennai Corporation. The biogas unit at the Chennai High School in Kottur was made possible by funding from Inner Wheel Club of Madras.

Institute of Climate & Environment (ICE) has also come on board as Knowledge Partners in this initiative, says a ROKA

communication.

The occasion was graced by the presence of Assistant commissioner, Zone 13, Kalidoss N; councilor for Ward 170 K. R. Kathirmurugan; members of the Inner wheel club of Madras headed by president Ruchita Saraogi, secretary Rukmini Amirapu and representatives from



different organisations and waste management enthusiasts, says the communication.

Headmistresses of Kottur school, Shanthi and Premalatha appreciated ROKA's work in waste management especially in GCC's schools.

Divya, the staff who has been part of ROKA's multiple projects in the Kamaraj Avenue Chennai high School, Adyar, was invited as a special guest to share her experience handling the plant, composting and the kitchen garden. She inspired and encouraged the staff in Kottur school with her speech, the communication notes. Other

ROKA's second food waste treatment plant had been installed at Chennai primary school at Thiruvanniyur in November 2025 with the support of Rotary Club of Madras. The food waste processed at this unit before the recent annual vacation is 1300 kg and the hours of cooking, 115.

ROKA set up its very first biogas unit at Chennai High School in Adyar. Between December 24 and March 26, food waste close to 5000 kg was processed; and the number of hours of bio-gas used in the kitchen, 400. The project was made possible by funding from EFI.

Structured handwriting programme for CBSE students



handwriting of students of classes X, XI and XII has to be clear, legible and presentation-worthy.

The students have to understand the CBSE online marking system, prepare to focus on legible handwriting, and work on presentation skills, in addition to writing the right answers, a press release said.

Thejomaya is offering a structured training programme focused on legibility, speed, and effective visual representation.

The programme involves pre-evaluation of existing handwriting and combines practical exercises, personalised guidance, and age-appropriate level books and techniques. For details, call 9381329450, 944467977.

The Central Board of Secondary Education answer sheets from the current academic year will be evaluated digitally. This means the process involves scanning answer sheets online. The

A new community space in Sholinganallur

Thangal Lake rejuvenated with the support of Infosys and Siruthuli was inaugurated recently

Infosys, in collaboration with Siruthuli, a not-for-profit organisation focused on environmental conservation and waterbody restoration, inaugurated the rejuvenated Thangal Lake in Sholinganallur recently. The inauguration was attended by ECR P. Saravanan, Member of the Legislative Assembly, Sholinganallur Constituency; Aftab Rasool, IAS, Regional Deputy Commissioner (South), Greater Chennai Corpo-

ration; Anil Kumar P.N., Senior Vice President and Center Head, Chennai, Infosys; and Niladri Prasad Mishra, Senior Vice President and Head of Global Infrastructure, Infosys, along with other dignitaries.

Supported through a CSR grant of over ₹ 5 crore, the project has transformed Thangal Lake into a more resilient urban ecosystem, said a release. The rejuvenation has nearly doubled the lake's storage capacity, from approximately 150 million litres to nearly 300 million litres, enhancing its ability to retain water, improve flood resilience, and support groundwater recharge. By addressing water pollution, flooding risks, and habitat degradation, the initiative demonstrates the role of nature-based solutions in strengthening

urban sustainability, said the release.

The restoration involved a range of ecological interventions, including dewatering, desilting, bund strengthening, sewage diversion, lagoon and island development, creation of floating wetlands, plantation, and fencing.

The project also focused on strengthening biodiversity through the creation of bird habitats, introduction of fruit-bearing trees, implementation of erosion-control measures, and deployment of natural treatment solutions.

The rejuvenated lake has been developed as a community space, with walking pathways, seating areas, a children's play area, an outdoor gym, and solar-powered lighting.

Age is indeed a number in Kamakshi Patti's universe



Kamakshi Paati has never entertained the idea of retiring from public service. And at age 98, there is no going back on that commitment. She was in attendance when a group of residents met the Velachery MLA R. Kumar for a discussion about local issues. She was an active participant in that interaction, and the demeanour she displayed, proved that age is indeed just a number if you have a lofty ideal to live for. Tree conservationist and environmentalist T.D. Babu was also part of the group that met the elected representative.

Events in Besant Nagar and Velachery today

Super Chennai is hosting various events at different venues in the city. On June 21, 'Sunrise Yoga' will be held from 6 a.m. to 7 a.m., inviting participants to begin their day with movement, mindfulness and the calming sounds of the ocean. The morning will also feature the specially curated art experience - 'Canvas by the Beach', starting at 5:30 a.m. on June 21 at Besant Nagar Beach. Celebrating World Music Day, Super Chennai will also host a Rock Music featuring Giddy Ho and Black Current at Phoenix Market City from 7 p.m. onwards.

For event registrations, schedules and updates, follow Super Chennai on Instagram or call 98405 83314

'Big Street Boys' drive vulture conservation initiative

Led by Raghunath Krishna, the 1986 batch of The Hindu Higher Secondary School is taking a critical message about this bird to school students. On June 18, labels carrying caricatures of vultures were distributed to students of Olcott school in Besant Nagar.

PRINCE FREDERICK

Raghunath Krishna is the flywheel driving an initiative by alumni of The Hindu Higher Secondary School in Triplicane, the 1986 batch of the school, self-christened Big Street Boys. If the christening had happened in 1986 the day after the farewell, they need not tender any explanation to Backstreet Boys (est. 1993). If so, the American pop boy band would owe the boys from Triplicane a clear explanation.

On the topic at hand, Raghunath's felt-tip caricature pen (sometimes, a pencil or a piece of charcoal) scripts what would easily pass off as a "reaching-out, giving-back" story. Trained by Raghunath, that pen has a demonstrated history of coaxing grotesquely attention-grabbing images out of the mundane. It is now at the centre of a visual vulture conservation project for school students.

These children would be reminded every day about the bird that is lagging in the numbers game. Raghunath has designed labels to be pasted on school notebooks, and these carry caricatured representations of vultures, portraying them not as carrion-devouring toughies, but cute and cuddle-worthy pets. The facts can be fed to the children later, get their attention first; that thinking is evidently at play.

He observes that his caricature pen is swayed by two philosophies: draw with the a symbol of the target group pinned in the tack board in front of you; and two, no design that ever was effective was put the viewer to sleep, overpowering



them with ennui. Hence no posters larded with data, just plain caricatures; info posters are necessary, but work only on the follow-up trail. Raghunath's lessons on caricaturing animals for conservation can be viewed at his You Tube Channel, Pencils Rock Academy.

On June 18, the alumni group

distributed a huge set of these labels to students of Olcott school at Besant Nagar and Raghunath spoke about why the vulture's place in the ecosystem cannot be filled by any other creature. Any discussion about vulture is loud on biomagnification: how man-made chemical toxins enter the food chain and af-

Raghunath Krishna; and at a session at Olcott school in Besant Nagar.
PHOTOS: S.R. RAGHUNATHAN AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



fect vultures as they pick at carrion.

This resources to create the labels were generated by the alumni group, members chipping in with contributions. Raghunath points out he would want the initiative to be extended to other schools including his alma mater, The Hindu Higher Secondary School, and that would depend on whether help beyond the batch is forthcoming.

This is not the first time Raghunath is interacting with students on the subject of species conservation. He is a brand strategist working with environment and nature conservation NGOs and creates awareness about the subject among communities living in the creases

between wildlife sanctuaries, particularly the younger generations in their midst. He has done this work among forest-based communities in Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Karnataka.

Among his other significant campaigns are the one on tiger reserves and another on elephants. Titled Elephany, the latter (an art project for children executed during the pandemic) celebrated jumbos, creatures seemingly breathed into life just for the felt-tip caricature pen.

Says Raghunath: "Every elephant is a gardener par excellence. In its lifetime, one without any major twists, an elephant will plant 18 lakh trees/ plants, spreading seeds through its dung."

Crooners beat commuting blues on Chennai's suburban trains

LAKSHMY HARIKRISHNAN



A Methuselah among train singing groups

Every day, at set hours in the morning and evening, a compartment in the local electric train on the Chennai Central-Tiruvallur suburban line morphs into a concert hall. Listening in to the voices from this decades-old amateur train singing group

On the 7.30 a.m. local from Tiruvallur to Chennai Central, compartment three (third from the motorman's cab) doubles as a jukebox. A one-off model, this jukebox cranks out live singing performances. First-timers are usually gobsmacked to hear vocal notes drowning the whir and whine of the suburban electric train and rising in cadence over the occasional clatter of its wheels. No professional singers in sight; nor trained musicians. And the singing can sometimes get ragged around the edges. Commuters are the voices, untrained, occasionally coarse-textured, but irresistibly real.

It is a group forged on the commute. People drawn from different walks of life, different offices, staying together on the commute because they have been singing together as the train carries them to work and home again. It is an "encore" on the 6.25 p.m. local from Chennai Central

to Tiruvallur, the group flexing their vocal cords again. This is a motivational reminder that between deadlines at work and chores at home, there is always a seat of relaxation to nestle into.

This "commuters choir" is as loosely defined as its daily playlist (Tamil and occasionally Hindi songs) and its roster of singers. As in any word-of-mouth tradition, there are multiple strands to its identity and history. Singers would reel off a diversity of names for the group. Some have given it a moniker, "Rail Ragam". Others hold on to a more idealised vision of it, choosing to keep it nameless, thereby deepening mystique. I. Jayaseelan, an advocate and a key member of the group, has an origin story for the group that melds with cosmogony upholding Big Bang Theory. "Nobody started it; the group was born suddenly. Nobody knows how," observes Jayaseelan. P. Venugopal, who joined the group in 2003 and contributes to the music

on the move with banjos, takes a "creationist" view, pointing out that a railway employee started it, and the young group was dandled and nourished by a diversity of commuters. Points of agreement include the group's longevity, close to 40 years old. Composition of the group: staff from Government Hospital, Secretariat, LIC, Harbour, law professionals associated with the High Court and from many private enterprises as well. There is no formal membership. People hop on and off the way they would a train.

However, to be able to hold court in a crowded compartment, a voice accustomed to the scrutiny of an audience helps. Those who sing invariably are given to the habit of singing in challenging settings. Jayaseelan reveals that he has a music troupe called "Inisai Saral". Music instruments such as rhythm pads are brought in by members. Even the sides of a compartment are used as surface for drumming.

The singers on the Chennai Central- Tiruvallur suburban line

On the commute, the singers are known to be offered small gifts, usually eats, if a listener is moved by the singing. "The best gifts are not materialistic; they come as appreciation which we accept with both hands," points out Jayaseelan. "Often, listeners get so lost in the music that they miss their destination, overshooting it by a few stations. Sometimes, they deliberately miss their destination to listen in to more songs."

A train compartment is a shared space, and some commuters might want the sanctity of such spaces to be protected, along with their peace. And that would mean hey do not sign up for the impromptu concert.

"Sometimes, the singers might get carried away, and get too loud for the non-participants' comfort. There have been instances where a singer has been 'led away' by the railway police. Not arrested, just led away," says Jayaseelan.

The advocate notes "the singing will not die down; and the phenomenon is hardly unique to the Chennai Central to Tiruvallur local. There is a long-lasting singing group on the Chennai Beach to Tambaram suburban line; and another on the Chennai Beach to Tiruvallur line."

What is more delectable than the singing in these train groups is the notes of camaraderie and relaxation that are struck silently. Strangers become companions. Weary commuters find solace. An old soul feels renewed, breathing in the air of nostalgia.

For details about the group, call 94441 07353

This unit changed tracks

From devotional to film songs, Pallavaram Return to Tambaram Local, this train commuters music group has experienced notable shifts but is still 'singing' strong

Suburban train singing groups rarely change tracks. Almost everything, from the timings and compartment to the route and genre, is "notated" with indelible ink. And the settings and processes continue without a semitone of variation. The singing group on the Tambaram to Chennai Beach suburban line strayed off this predictable course.

First up, the route. Around 30 years ago, the group whirled into soundscape on the Pallavaram Return, a service originating at Pallavaram station at 9.30 a.m. and screeching to a halt at Chennai Beach. Om Balachandran, employed as public relations inspector at the Anna Salai post office, is by his own admission, a member of this group not by the strength of his vocal cords, but his cochlea. He can sound Descartian if he chose to: "I listen, therefore I am (a member of this group)." And this is what Balachandran "the listener" has to say: the route changed around the pandemic when "Pallavaram Return" service was waved into retirement. Since then the group is associated with the 8.50 a.m. Tambaram local. The "mobile concert hall" is the third compartment from the guard van.

"Still, a majority of the members are from Pallavaram and Chromepet," Balachandran emphasises. The group has had another notable shift: from hymns to hits. In its early days, devotional songs were its staple. And then filmy earworms (Ta-



The group in 2011 when it was called Pallavaram Return Singing Group; and (below) now as Tambaram Local Singing Group. The music ends every day at Chennai Beach. PHOTOS: A.MURALIDHARAN AND SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

mil and occasional Hindi songs) wriggled into the centre stage. Now, there is a mix with film songs in a predominant position. However, every singing session is ushered in with a devotional song.

S. Harishankar, whose daily commute transports him to the Secretariat where he is in a team that takes care of all matters pertaining to the Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly, the premises and the processes, has been a long-time member. He has reasons to view this compartment as a relief, even an escape from the mundane and persistent burdens of life. And also as a space for companionship.

When it burst on the scene, the group was composed of friends, ten of them. And the number stands at around 30, a clutch of them (three to four) trained for professional stage singing. The thirty does not account for the silent participants, seemingly distant but engrossed in the proceedings.

In fact, the fandom of this group, nicknamed

"The Train Friends", stretches across tracks. I. Jayaseelan, an advocate with the Madras High Court who is part of the singing group on the Chennai Central to Tiruvallur suburban line, detrains from his regular commute to board this train just for the singing.

Besides the camaraderie among members, which is extended to counterparts from singing groups on other suburban locals such as Jayaseelan, there is respect for fellow passengers, even those frowning at the "concert". Balachandran explains: "Occasionally, when the singing group receives a negative response, even if one passenger objects to the singing, saying it prevents them from having a quiet journey, we immediately stop singing." It takes courage to pursue one's passion, and social consciousness to keep it tempered. This group has evidently got this two-sided equation uncannily right.

'Yoga Parks' to come up at two iconic institutions in Chennai

Under an Ayush initiative, Regional Research Institute of Unani Medicine in Royapuram and National Institute of Siddha in Tambaram are clearing the decks for the establishment of spaces that promote yoga



PHOTO SANDEEP SAXENA

LIFFYTHOMAS

Two institutions from Chennai – National Institute of Siddha in Tambaram and Regional Research Institute of Unani Medicine in Royapuram – figure among the list of spaces in various that are to be promoted as Yoga Parks.

An initiative of the Ministry of Ayush, Government of India, Yoga Park Portal encourages corporates, resident welfare associations and other like-minded groups to promote these spaces for wellness programmes.

As on the date, the portal has more than 60 parks across cities registered with them with four being from Tamil Nadu.

A 'Yoga Park' would serve as a dedicated space developed within existing 'parks' in both rural and urban areas, with support from Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives of companies.

These parks are designed to provide a structured, accessible, and inclusive environment for the regular practice of yoga and wellness activities, says a note on the website. The initiative aims to promote healthy lifestyles, community participation, and preventive healthcare by offering nearby residents a serene and well-equipped space for daily yoga practice and holistic well-being.

On June 21, which is International Day of Yoga, both these institutions will be hosting Yoga Day and other wellness programmes.

The huge space that these institutions have is one reason why they easily qualify to be promoted as Yoga Parks.

National Institute of Siddha, for instance, is spread across 14 acres and runs a medical college along with the hospital. Yoga is offered as a speciality and is also prescribed to patients. The Institute is opening up its campus for corporates to invest in improving its infrastructure. "We have identified an open area roughly measuring 200 sq metre within our campus, which can be promoted for yoga, so we have registered for funding under CSR," says a senior staff with the Institute.

For more details, visit <https://yoga.ayush.gov.in/yogapark>



GANGA SRIDHAR

Sustainable Sparks drive, an initiative launched on World Environment Day 2026 by EcoKconnectors, invited individuals and businesses to share eco-friendly practices. Entries from a diversity of communities poured in. And they were wide-ranging, straddling segregation and composting, terrace gardens and upcycling and solar electrification, water conservation, the how-to of avoiding food waste and traditional eco-friendly cooking entries. Each practice was celebrated as a spark capable of igniting many more sustainable actions. Through videos and writeups, EcoKconnectors showcased these inspiring contributions, motivating neighbourhoods to embrace sustainability and recognise the power of small steps in shaping a greener future.

The sparks were slotted into different categories.

Garden Sparks

Amidst Chennai's rising concrete skyline, a few cherished homes and thoughtful apartments still nurture green sanctuaries. These spaces echo ancient practices: feeding cows with rice water, leaving bowls for birds and strays, and offering fruits to squirrels. Within them thrive Mango, Jamun, Neem, Jackfruit, Guava, coconut and Plantain trees, creating forest-like havens for chirping birds and playful squirrels. Our Green Sparks contributors include Shameem from Raja Street, Dr. R. Chandrasekharan, Deepa Raghunath, Lalitha Iyer, Ravi Kumar from RA Puram, Sushela from Neelangarai and Mala Ramesh from Krishnagiri beautifully extend their garden from the ground to the terrace and balcony, showcasing efficient space use. Herbs, fruiting, and flowering

Sparks of sustainability

Following an announcement on World Environment day, residents of Mandaveli, R.A. Puram, Mylapore and Adyar have clogged EcoKconnectors' inbox with accounts and images of their green lifestyles



▼ Deepa Raghunath under her solar rooftop; Ravi Kumar at his garden; and Bhuvana Pasupathi with her indigenous composter upcycled from an old plastic stool. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



plants thrive there, providing puja flowers every day straight from their terrace.

Composting Sparks

Savitha Suresh Kanna proudly showcased her three-tier Kumbha composter and her harvest, while Bhuvana Pasupathi creatively repurposed an old enclosed stool into a composter. Ravi Kumar shared his home composting methods.

Despite busy schedules, they compost puja flowers and kitchen waste, reaping rich, earthy compost. Deepa from Gopalapuram says: "I practise eco-friendly habits daily such as recycling newspapers, washed and dried Aavin packets plastics, segregating kitchen waste, and donating usable clothes, bags and shoes to orphanages or old age homes".

The Munira Shoaib Welfare Trust organised a Waste Collection and Segregation Drive at Voora Oceans 27, Tondiarpet, promoting responsible waste management through awareness and participation, inspiring communities toward sustainable living practices and shared their community level sustainability initiative as a spark with us. It sends a powerful reminder that even the busiest among us can carve out moments to nurture the environment.

Water Sparks

Water conservation sparks by reusing RO outlet water for mopping the floor and washing purposes was shared by V. Ramakrishna and Ishita.

Upcycling Sparks

Upcycling Sparks Vidya Madi-vannan embodies the spirit of Best out of Waste. For over a decade, she has composted household waste and transformed discarded items into creative art forms. Choosing ecofriendly products, she avoids plastic and embraces bio enzymes safe for earth and people. She also uses reusable period panties and upcycles wedding invitations into earrings, paper scraps

into bowls, medicine bottles and broken mirrors into décor, and old wood into name boards, turning waste into sustainable beauty.

Solar Sparks

Deepa Raghunath of R.A. Puram and Susheela Bala of Neelangarai showcased solar rooftops, proving Chennai's abundant sunlight makes solar electrification essential, drastically reducing electricity bills sustainably.

Cooking Sparks

Kanthi Neelamegham of Raja Street shared a video using the traditional Ammi kall for grinding, saving electricity, enhancing taste, and keeping herself flexible and fit.

Sustainable Business Sparks

"Rain Bio Enzymes" Priyadarshini showcased sustainable business practices, creating handmade natural soaps and cleaning liquids with bioenzymes which are eco-friendly, cost-effective alternatives to expensive chemical detergents.

"Three Square Meals," Rohan runs a cloud kitchen operating from Adyar, delivers comforting corporate and daily meals in compostable bagasse boxes lined with banana leaves eliminating plastics and redefining sustainable food packaging.

"Aparna" a Mylapore based garment store and workshop embodies sustainability. Powered by solar energy, built with reclaimed wood, terracotta, recycled plastic and natural stone, it minimises waste. Her garments use natural fabrics, recycled cotton tags, cornstarch packaging, and scrap fabric repurposed into purses or kids' clothes—reflecting simplicity, responsibility, and ecofriendly values throughout.

Daniel's inspired SWM Spark emphasises that what feels excess to one can be a need for another. During his London project, he discovered the Olio and Trash Nothing apps, where volunteers and individuals share surplus food, grocery and items instantly, preventing waste. From rice to fans, everything found purpose. He believes such platforms should expand globally, making responsible sharing effortless. He hopes similar systems will help connect his usable cycle and other items to the right recipients in India as well. We received sustainability sparks from far and wide and this one was all the way from Mala Ramesh of Krishnagiri. Mala says: "I am a small scale farmer trying to grow forest trees along with fruit trees for birds in an organic method. We have reduced the use of cement by opting for compressed stabilised earthen bricks in our house. Water is conserved in pond, swale apart from soak pits all around. In addition, the natural gradients in the land have been restructured to direct rainwater to recharge bore wells. These are our small contributions to afforestation".

Christwood School *marches past a milestone*

At the institution's Decennial Thanksgiving Celebrations, outstanding students were honoured

Christwood School marked a significant milestone in its journey with its Decennial Thanksgiving Celebrations, commemorating 10 years of transformative learning, character formation and holistic development.

Established in 2016, Christwood School has grown into one of Chennai's leading ICSE institutions, nurturing nearly 2,000 students through a distinctive blend of academic rigour, values-based education and future-focused learning, said a press release. Over the past decade, the school has built an outstanding reputation for excellence in academics, music, sports, leadership development and co-curricular



David C. Paul and Rev Abraham Thomas present the Christwood Trophy for the Best Outgoing Student to Judah Jeslan Chester. Also seen in the picture are S. Alfred Devaprasad and Vijayakumar, along with parents.

achievements at regional, national and international levels, it added.

The institution is widely recognised for its innovative programmes in STEM Education, Robotics and Artificial Intelligence, Nature Ecology, Career Guidance and Entrepreneurship, supported by modern infrastructure and technology-enabled classrooms.

Delivering the decennial thanksgiving address, David C. Paul, Exec-

utive Chairman of Globus Medical Inc., USA, congratulated the Christwood community on its remarkable accomplishments within a short span of ten years.

Reflecting on the rapid technological advancements shaping the modern world, particularly the emergence of Artificial Intelligence, Paul emphasised the importance of strong foundational values in preparing young people for an increas-

ingly dynamic and uncertain future. He noted that Christwood's emphasis on character, integrity, discipline and service would enable students to remain focused, resilient and progressive amidst global change.

S. Alfred Devaprasad, CEO and Correspondent of Christwood School, reflected on the institution's inspiring journey from a fledgling school established in 2016 to a vibrant centre of learning recognised

for academic excellence and innovation. He acknowledged the unwavering support of parents, teachers, students, alumni and well-wishers who have contributed to the school's growth and success.

The celebrations were attended by several eminent personalities, including P.W.C. Davidar, IAS (Retd.), Rev. Dr. Abraham Thomas, Abraham Mani, Joshua Madan along with guests from the fields of education, industry and public service. A highlight of the evening was the performance by Christwood's 300-member choir and orchestra, whose inspiring musical presentation captivated the audience and showcased the institution's commitment to artistic excellence. The event also featured the presentation of the prestigious Christwood Trophy for the Best Outgoing Student, jointly awarded to Judah Jeslan Chester and Emily Nathanian in recognition of their exceptional academic performance, leadership qualities and outstanding contribution to school life.

Preparing students for a future-ready workforce

The Hindustan Institute of Technology and Science (HITS), Padur, in collaboration with the National Skill Development Corporation (NSDC) and Ethnotech Academy, will soon launch a future skills centre to train students in emerging technologies.

The Hindustan Center for Future Skills will prepare students for careers in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning, Data Science and Analytics, Cloud Computing, Cyber Security, Industrial Automation and Robotics, AR/VR and Metaverse Technologies, IoT and Smart Systems, Digital Marketing and Project Management.

The centre is being established to bridge the gap between academic educa-

tion and rapidly evolving industry requirements by providing students with practical training, live industry projects, internships, and experiential learning opportunities.

Through collaborations with leading technology companies - IBM, Apple, AWS, Microsoft, Cisco, Intel, Schneider Electric, Autodesk, Adobe, Meta, PMI, Pearson, Tally, and MathWorks- the center will provide globally relevant learning experiences and industry-recognized credentials.

Non-HITS students can enrol with a minimum +2 qualification.

For details, call M. Murali Krishna (Academics) at 9989086120; for admissions, call 8668093935.

Value education programme

The International Society for Krishna Consciousness has launched a weekly value education programme for children and teens, designed to nurture spiritual and moral values through fun-filled sessions. The programme runs from mid-June to March, with one weekly session lasting between 1.5 and 2 hours. This is offered online and offline across the city, with English or Tamil as the medium of instruction.

Centered around the theme 'Dashavatar', the programme talks about Indian culture. Children (ages 6-12) will enjoy fun-filled learning through stories, quizzes, shlokas, bhajans, fireless cooking, and arts and crafts.

Teens (ages 13-17) will be engaged in stimulating, theme-based activities, including debates, group discussions, mind mapping, and Just A Minute sessions.

For registration, visit <https://bpss.fun/bpss-annual-program/>. For further inquiries, call 8072599295.

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Montessori educators receive directorship award



▼ Hema Sridharan and Priya Grace Christabell (left) receiving the citation from Uma Shanker and Shalini Gopalakrishna, president and treasurer respectively of the Indian Montessori Center - Bengaluru. PHOTOS: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Hema Sridharan and Priya Grace Christabell, faculty with Indian Montessori Training Courses (IMTC) - Chennai, were recently conferred with the 'Independent Directorship Award'.

The directorship is awarded to

educators after a rigorous process that includes the submission of theoretical papers and practical training experience, both of which extends for over a few years.

The citations were presented by Uma Shanker, president, and Shalini Gopalakrishna, treasurer

of the Indian Montessori Center (IMC), Bengaluru.

An IMC-certified director of training courses can set up a teacher training centre, which is an important milestone in further spreading Montessori education in Tamil Nadu, a release stated.

The first teacher training

centre in Tamil Nadu was set up in 1998 by Uma Shanker. Till date, over 150 teachers employed in Greater Chennai Corporation schools have undergone the Montessori teacher training conducted by IMTC-Chennai and Kalvi Trust for Research and Education, the release added.

MSME workshops in Guindy

Entrepreneurship Development & Innovation Institute in Guindy is conducting a workshop on "mobile phone repair and service" from June 23 to 25.

Participants will learn about fundamentals of the mobile phone technology.

The institute is also organising a workshop on "E-Sevai" on June 23 and 24. Participants will learn about issuing various certificates including: income, nativity, community, legal heir, small and marginal farmer and also about certificates relating to welfare schemes of the government.

Another workshop on Foundations of AI and Digital Marketing will be held from June 23 to 25.

Yet another workshop on using Government e-Marketplace (GeM) portal will be held on June 24.

For details, call 8668100181/ 9360221280.

Thirukkural competition in August

Shriram Ilakkiya Kazhagam, the literary wing of Shriram Group, is conducting its annual State-level Thirukkural competition on August 29 and 30 at CSI Jessie Moses Matriculation Higher Secondary School in Anna Nagar and at Vels Vidyashram in Pallavaram respectively. It is meant for school, college (including post graduation) and polytechnic students.

According to a press release, the events include: elocution, drawing and painting, and essay writing.

Those interested to take part



can collect the application forms from the branches of Shriram Chits or download from www.shriramchits.com Shriram Ilakkiya Kazhagam has been conducting this competition every year since 1988 with the aim of inculcating the values and teachings of Thirukkural among youngsters.

Job fair on July 11 at Loyola College



The Rise & Give Life Foundation is organising a job fair on July 11 at Loyola College. According to a press release, around 500 companies will take part. This includes companies from manufacturing sector, banking and finance, IT and ITES, healthcare, pharmaceutical, education, logistics, tourism, and retail. No fee will be charged for pre-registered candidates but a fee of ₹100 will be charged from those who attend without prior registration, adds the press release.

To register visit, www.givelifes.com or call 75300 88293.

Ticket booking time reduced to 5 seconds in CUMTA's app



The Chennai One App of Chennai Unified Metropolitan Transport Authority has introduced a new feature called "One Click Payment: CUMTA UPI." According to a press release, the feature reduces the ticket booking time from 60 seconds to five seconds. Also, commuters can avail this facility to get the first ticket for ₹1.

CUMTA encourages the public to use this facility to travel seamlessly using the Chennai One App, adds the press release.

Awareness programme on Yoga

In observance of International Yoga Day, Annai Veilankanni's College of Arts & Science in association with Brahma Kumaris organised a programme to spread awareness on physical and mental well-being through Yoga and meditation.

There was a practical session on Yoga; and students and faculty members took part, adds the



HCL Foundation invites applications for grant

HCL Foundation, the corporate social responsibility wing of HCL Tech - India has announced Edition XII of HCL Tech Grant. According to a press release, it is a grant which will be provided to non-governmental organisations working in the realm of environment, health, and education in rural India.

As part of the project, the foundation has allocated ₹24 crore as grant, adds the press release. The last date for submitting applications is June 30, 2026.

Applications can be downloaded from www.hclfoundation.org/hcltech-grant.

The NGOs will be selected by a jury, adds the press release

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